



Flying taxis by 2020?

It's 2017 and many of the utopian fantasies we harboured thanks to science fiction seem to be materialising in reality now. After Larry Page's Kitty Hawk hovercraft prototype successfully completed its maiden test flight and a German startup called Lilium triumphantly flew the world's first entirely electric vertical take-off and landing car/jet, cab hailing service Uber is also trying to spread its wings.

At the ongoing Elevate Conference in Dallas, San Francisco-based Uber shared its plans to launch an on-demand flying taxi service in Texas and Dubai by 2020. That's just three years from now. Uber's ambitious plans include electrically powered air taxis capable of vertical takeoff and landing (VTOL) from pads that the company calls "vertiports." Of course these air-taxis don't even exist right now, and what does this mean for air traffic control? There are those that think this is a publicity stunt because Uber has been in the news for all the wrong reasons recently...

<http://dgit.in/2020taxi>

Taliban says plant more trees... or else!

Afghanistan suffers from devastating environmental issues. The long war between the Taliban and the US has destroyed many regions of the country, besides, there are severe problems with deforestation and a thriving illegal timber trade. Furthermore, since electricity and gas is a pipe-dream for most, the country's population still uses wood-burning stoves for cooking and heating up their food.

Recently, the current leader of the militant group, Mawlawi Hibatullah Akhundzada released a new announcement on social media urging Afghans to "plant one or several fruit or non-fruit trees for the beautification of Earth and the benefit of almighty Allah's creations".

Many criticise this move though, and claim that the Taliban's actions have always contradicted their statements, and this is another instance of them hoodwinking the public into ignoring all of the destruction they have caused. Today, they are more often associated with underground opium trade, terrorism, logging, etc. Although the political views of the Taliban seem to forever be at loggerheads with the rest of the world (largely), this is one instance where everyone agrees. Human caused climate change is real. However, isn't it funny how the terrorists now seem to be the only ones bothered to do something about it?

<http://dgit.in/AK47tree>



The Success-Killing Mistakes



What does it take to be truly successful? Many have pointed to grit-the ability to

persevere in the face of obstacles and setbacks-as a key quality that helps some people reach huge achievements while others fall short. But, it turns out, there's good grit and bad grit

<http://dgit.in/KillSuccess>

Infographic for aliens



How do you explain life on Earth without using human language? With

graphic design, of course. 45 years ago, NASA launched simple line drawings (detailing all of humanity), engraved it onto a set of identical golden plaques and rocketed them to space.

<http://dgit.in/45NASA>

Fighting ISIS with algorithms



We've not reached the stage of autonomous killing machines quite

yet, but the US Pentagon will soon employ machine learning algorithms to help intelligence analysts identify Islamic State fighters in thousands of hours of drone surveillance footage.

<http://dgit.in/droneISIS>